Vikas Manch, were walking with him. The tribal activist had probably already spoken to Rahul ji, because I saw Nikhil Dey discussing something with him then. He was talking about bringing a law on social security for gig workers. Nikhil ji was saying that there were about 2.5 lakh gig workers in Rajasthan, who worked in various app-based companies such as Ola, Uber, Swiggy and Zomato, but did not have any social security system. So if the Rajasthan government came up with a scheme or a law for the welfare of gig workers, it would be unique in the whole world.

Rahul ji was not only taking a serious interest in this conversation, but was also giving his views and asking questions. Later, during the lunch break, there was further dialogue on this topic between Rahul ji, the chief minister and Nikhil ji, and the conversation saw significant progress. And finally, the promise made by Rahul ji during the Bharat Jodo Yatra became a law and, today, Rajasthan is the first and only state in the country where the state Congress government has passed the Platform Based Gig Workers (Registration and Welfare) Act, 2023. According to the Act, a board is to be formed, which will collect money from the companies and use this to ensure there is welfare and social security among gig workers. The government initially invested Rs 200 crore in this.

As I was getting closer to where Rahul ji was, I met the Baytu MLA Harish Chaudhary. He said loudly from a distance, ‘Bhanwar ji, Ram Ram!’ I looked back and said hello to him. He asked, ‘When did you come?’ I told him that I had reached that very morning. After this I reached the second row, where I met Sitaram Lamba, who was overseeing training activities in the Youth Congress and was the president of the Rajasthan Youth Board. He warmly welcomed me and expressed his happiness at our meeting.

I was soon in the line where Rahul ji was walking. But before meeting him, I met my own constituency’s MLA and state revenue minister Ramlal Jat in the first line. He shook my hand and expressed happiness that I was there. At that time Sachin Pilot and Hemaram Chaudhary were also walking in the first row along with Rahul Gandhi. Nikhil Dey was still talking; he introduced me to Rahul ji before leaving.